A CALMER GIFTING PRINTABLE

Handmade or Bought?

Some gifts want your hands. Some want your credit card. Both are full of love. This planner helps you decide which is which *before* the deadline turns a fun project into a 2 a.m. glue-gun emergency.

How to use it

1. One row per person. Write the idea, then circle **handmade** or **bought** — honestly, based on the time you actually have.
2. For handmade rows, estimate the real time and supplies cost. Double your first guess; that's usually the true number.
3. Fill in a **start by** date on page 3, then let the boxes on this sheet track started / finished.
4. It's completely allowed to switch a row from handmade to bought halfway. The point is the person, not the process.

What's inside

- **Page 2** — the planner table: idea, route, time, cost, progress.
- **Page 3** — a friendly decision guide, a supplies list, and start-by dates.

> **A kind note:** a homemade gift made calmly says “I thought of you for weeks.” A homemade gift made frantically says “I didn't sleep.” Same glue gun, very different message — plan for the first one.

Print at 100% (“Actual size”), US Letter, portrait. Prints nicely in black & white. Personal use: print as many copies as you like.

Handmade or Bought? — Planner

Circle the route, estimate honestly, and let the little boxes carry the progress.

Recipient	The idea	Hand-made / Bought	Time needed	Supplies $	Started	Finished
		circle one			☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
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					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐

Choosing With Your Energy in Mind

Neither column is “better.” The right one is the one you'll still be glad about on the big day.

Lean handmade when…

- the person values time and attention more than things;
- you genuinely enjoy making it — even the fiddly parts;
- it can be made in batches (jam, bread, ornaments) for many people at once;
- the calendar says you have room. If it doesn't, that's the answer.

Lean bought when…

- the season is already full and your energy is a real budget line;
- someone on your list specifically wants a thing only money can find;
- a small handmade touch (a tag, ribbon, note) can warm up a store-bought gift — hybrid counts.

Supplies to gather

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Start-by dates (write them, protect them)

Batch / big project: _____

Small handmade pieces: _____

Shopping day: _____ Wrapping day: _____

Permission slip: you may simplify, outsource, or buy the backup plan at any time without guilt. Done and kind beats ambitious and missing, every single year.